

AYE
FIT HUB

• STR • DAY 8

Progressive Overload

The Secret to Never Plateauing

Day 8 of 30 | Build Phase Begins

■ WEEK 2 — BUILD PHASE

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- 5 overload methods explained
- Volume tracking system
- Build Phase strength circuit

01 | What Is Progressive Overload?

Your body adapts to stress. The first time you did 10 push-ups it was hard. The tenth time it was easy. That is adaptation — and it is the reason most people plateau after 3–4 weeks of training. **Progressive overload** is the deliberate, systematic increase of training demand over time so your body never fully adapts and is always forced to grow stronger.

Without it, you maintain fitness. With it, you build it. This principle is the single biggest difference between people who transform their bodies and people who spin their wheels for months doing the same thing.

"If it doesn't challenge you, it doesn't change you."

02 | The 5 Methods of Progressive Overload

You do not have to add weight every session. There are five ways to progressively overload — rotate through them based on where you are in the program.

Method	How to Apply	Example	Best For
More Reps	Same weight/exercise, add 1–23 reps	3×10 → 3×12 push-ups	Weeks 1–2
More Sets	Add one extra set to a key exercise	3 sets → 4 sets squats	Weeks 2–3
Less Rest	Reduce rest period by 10–15 sec	60 sec rest → 45 sec rest	Weeks 2–4
Harder Variation	Upgrade to a more demanding movement	Push-up → Archer push-up	Weeks 3–4
More Volume	Add a second session or an extra exercise	4 exercises → 5 exercises	Weeks 3–4

■ INFO — The 2% Rule

Aim to improve by just 2% each session. 1 extra rep. 5 seconds less rest. One harder variation every 2 weeks. Small increments compound dramatically — 2% per session over 30 days = a completely different level of fitness.

03 | Week 1 vs Week 2 — How Your Training Changes

Variable	Foundation (Week 1)	Build (Week 2)	Change
Work interval	30 sec	40 sec	+33%
Rest interval	30 sec	20 sec	−33%
Rounds	2–3	3–4	+1 round
Exercise variant	Basic	Slightly harder	e.g. squat → jump squat
Sessions/week	4 workouts	5 workouts	+1 session
Focus	Learning movement	Building capacity	Volume ↑

■■ WARNING — Do Not Skip Ahead

Progressive overload only works if you have a true baseline. If you skipped or modified exercises heavily in Week 1, repeat the Foundation level for one more week before advancing. Building on a weak foundation leads to injury.

04 | Day 8 Workout — Build Phase Strength Circuit

Format: 40 sec work / 20 sec rest | **Rounds:** 4 | **Equipment:** None | **Time:** ~30 minutes | **Goal:** Beat your Week 1 rep counts by at least 1 rep each

WARM-UP (4 min)		
Exercise	Duration	Notes
Jumping jacks	60 sec	Medium pace, full range
Leg swings front-back	30 sec	15 each leg
Arm cross swings	30 sec	Across chest, open wide
Hip circles	30 sec	Both directions
Inchworm + push-up	90 sec	5 slow reps — prime the whole body

MAIN CIRCUIT — 4 Rounds (40 sec work / 20 sec rest)				
#	Exercise (Week 2 Variant)	Week 1 Version	Target	Your Reps
1	Jump Squat	Bodyweight Squat	+1 rep/round	___
2	Diamond Push-Up	Standard Push-Up	+1 rep/round	___
3	Jump Lunge	Reverse Lunge	+1 rep/round	___
4	Plank Shoulder Taps	Forearm Plank	Beat time by 5s	___
5	Single-Leg Glute Bridge	Standard Glute Bridge	+2 reps	___
6	Burpee + Push-Up	Standard Burpee	+1 rep/round	___
7	Mountain Climbers (fast)	Mountain Climbers	+3 reps/round	___
8	Hollow Body Hold	Dead Bug	Beat time by 5s	___

■ INFO — Can't Do the Harder Variant?

Use the Week 1 version but add 1 extra round instead. Progressive overload by volume is just as valid as by variation. Never sacrifice form for progression — bad form is regression, not progress.

05 | Volume Tracking System

Track your total volume per session: **Sets × Reps = Volume**. Each week your total volume should be 5–10% higher than the previous week. Use this log every session from now on.

Exercise	Week 1 Sets×Reps	Week 2 Sets×Reps	Volume Change
Push-up variant	3 × ____	4 × ____	____
Squat variant	3 × ____	4 × ____	____
Lunge variant	2 × ____	3 × ____	____
Plank / core hold	2 × ____ sec	3 × ____ sec	____
Hip thrust variant	3 × ____	3 × ____	____
Cardio exercise	2 × ____ sec	3 × ____ sec	____
TOTAL VOLUME	____	____	____% change

■ TIP — The 10% Rule

Never increase total weekly volume by more than 10% in a single week. Jumping from 100 to 150 reps in one week is how injuries happen. Slow, consistent increases beat aggressive spikes every time.

06 | Day 8 Self-Check Question

Complete before Day 9.

"Comparing today's workout to Day 1 — which exercise improved the most, and which exercise still feels like your weakest point? What is your specific plan to address that weakness in Week 2?"

Your answer:

Next up — Day 9:
Tabata Training — 4 Minutes That Change Everything

Community & support:
t.me/ayetechub